

Design System Inspired by Lovable

1. Visual Theme & Atmosphere

Lovable's website radiates warmth through restraint. The entire page sits on a creamy, parchment-toned background (`#f7f4ed`) that immediately separates it from the cold-white conventions of most developer tool sites. This isn't minimalism for minimalism's sake — it's a deliberate choice to feel approachable, almost analog, like a well-crafted notebook. The near-black text (`#1c1c1c`) against this warm cream creates a contrast ratio that's easy on the eyes while maintaining sharp readability.

The custom Camera Plain Variable typeface is the system's secret weapon. Unlike geometric sans-serifs that signal "tech company," Camera Plain has a humanist warmth — slightly rounded terminals, organic curves, and a comfortable reading rhythm. At display sizes (48px–60px), weight 600 with aggressive negative letter-spacing (-0.9px to -1.5px) compresses headlines into confident, editorial statements. The font uses `ui-sans-serif`, `system-ui` as fallbacks, acknowledging that the custom typeface carries the brand personality.

What makes Lovable's visual system distinctive is its opacity-driven depth model. Rather than using a traditional gray scale, the system modulates `#1c1c1c` at varying opacities (0.03, 0.04, 0.4, 0.82–0.83) to create a unified tonal range. Every shade of gray on the page is technically the same hue — just more or less transparent. This creates a visual coherence that's nearly impossible to achieve with arbitrary hex values. The border system follows suit: `1px solid #eaeaea` for light divisions and `1px solid rgba(28, 28, 28, 0.4)` for stronger interactive boundaries.

****Key Characteristics:****

- Warm parchment background (`#f7f4ed`) — not white, not beige, a deliberate cream that feels hand-selected
- Camera Plain Variable typeface with humanist warmth and editorial letter-spacing at display sizes
- Opacity-driven color system: all grays derived from `#1c1c1c` at varying transparency levels
- Inset shadow technique on buttons: `rgba(255,255,255,0.2) 0px 0.5px 0px 0px inset, rgba(0,0,0,0.2) 0px 0px 0px 0.5px inset`
- Warm neutral border palette: `#eaeaea` for subtle, `rgba(28,28,28,0.4)` for interactive elements
- Full-pill radius (`9999px`) used extensively for action buttons and icon containers
- Focus state uses `rgba(0,0,0,0.1) 0px 4px 12px` shadow for soft, warm emphasis
- shadcn/ui + Radix UI component primitives with Tailwind CSS utility styling

2. Color Palette & Roles

Primary

- ****Cream**** (`#f7f4ed`): Page background, card surfaces, button surfaces. The foundation — warm, paper-like, human.

- **Charcoal** (`#1c1c1c`): Primary text, headings, dark button backgrounds. Not pure black — organic warmth.
- **Off-White** (`#fcfbf8`): Button text on dark backgrounds, subtle highlight. Barely distinguishable from pure white.

Neutral Scale (Opacity-Based)

- **Charcoal 100%** (`#1c1c1c`): Primary text, headings, dark surfaces.
- **Charcoal 83%** (`rgba(28,28,28,0.83)`): Strong secondary text.
- **Charcoal 82%** (`rgba(28,28,28,0.82)`): Body copy.
- **Muted Gray** (`#5f5f5d`): Secondary text, descriptions, captions.
- **Charcoal 40%** (`rgba(28,28,28,0.4)`): Interactive borders, button outlines.
- **Charcoal 4%** (`rgba(28,28,28,0.04)`): Subtle hover backgrounds, micro-tints.
- **Charcoal 3%** (`rgba(28,28,28,0.03)`): Barely-visible overlays, background depth.

Surface & Border

- **Light Cream** (`#eae4e4`): Card borders, dividers, image outlines. The warm divider line.
- **Cream Surface** (`#f7f4ed`): Card backgrounds, section fills — same as page background for seamless integration.

Interactive

- **Ring Blue** (`#3b82f6` at 50% opacity): `--tw-ring-color`, Tailwind focus ring.
- **Focus Shadow** (`rgba(0,0,0,0.1) 0px 4px 12px`): Focus and active state shadow — soft, warm, diffused.

Inset Shadows

- **Button Inset** (`rgba(255,255,255,0.2) 0px 0.5px 0px 0px inset, rgba(0,0,0,0.2) 0px 0px 0px 0.5px inset, rgba(0,0,0,0.05) 0px 1px 2px 0px`): The signature multi-layer inset shadow on dark buttons.

3. Typography Rules

Font Family

- **Primary**: `Camera Plain Variable`, with fallbacks: `ui-sans-serif, system-ui`
- **Weight range**: 400 (body/reading), 480 (special display), 600 (headings/emphasis)
- **Feature**: Variable font with continuous weight axis — allows fine-tuned intermediary weights like 480.

Hierarchy

Role	Font	Size	Weight	Line Height	Letter Spacing	Notes
Display Hero	Camera Plain Variable	60px (3.75rem)	600	1.00–1.10 (tight)	-1.5px	Maximum impact, editorial
Display Alt	Camera Plain Variable	60px (3.75rem)	480	1.00 (tight)	normal	Lighter hero variant
Section Heading	Camera Plain Variable	48px (3.00rem)	600	1.00 (tight)	-1.2px	Feature section titles

| Sub-heading | Camera Plain Variable | 36px (2.25rem) | 600 | 1.10 (tight) | -0.9px |
 Sub-sections |
 | Card Title | Camera Plain Variable | 20px (1.25rem) | 400 | 1.25 (tight) | normal | Card
 headings |
 | Body Large | Camera Plain Variable | 18px (1.13rem) | 400 | 1.38 | normal | Introductions |
 | Body | Camera Plain Variable | 16px (1.00rem) | 400 | 1.50 | normal | Standard reading text
 |
 | Button | Camera Plain Variable | 16px (1.00rem) | 400 | 1.50 | normal | Button labels |
 | Button Small | Camera Plain Variable | 14px (0.88rem) | 400 | 1.50 | normal | Compact
 buttons |
 | Link | Camera Plain Variable | 16px (1.00rem) | 400 | 1.50 | normal | Underline decoration |
 | Link Small | Camera Plain Variable | 14px (0.88rem) | 400 | 1.50 | normal | Footer links |
 | Caption | Camera Plain Variable | 14px (0.88rem) | 400 | 1.50 | normal | Metadata, small
 text |

Principles

- **Warm humanist voice**: Camera Plain Variable gives Lovable its approachable personality. The slightly rounded terminals and organic curves contrast with the sharp geometric sans-serifs used by most developer tools.
- **Variable weight as design tool**: The font supports continuous weight values (e.g., 480), enabling nuanced hierarchy beyond standard weight stops. Weight 480 at 60px creates a display style that feels lighter than semibold but stronger than regular.
- **Compression at scale**: Headlines use negative letter-spacing (-0.9px to -1.5px) for editorial impact. Body text stays at normal tracking for comfortable reading.
- **Two weights, clear roles**: 400 (body/UI/links/buttons) and 600 (headings/emphasis). The narrow weight range creates hierarchy through size and spacing, not weight variation.

4. Component Stylings

Buttons

Primary Dark (Inset Shadow)

- Background: ``#1c1c1c``
- Text: ``#fcfbf8``
- Padding: 8px 16px
- Radius: 6px
- Shadow: ``rgba(0,0,0,0) 0px 0px 0px 0px, rgba(0,0,0,0) 0px 0px 0px 0px,``
`rgba(255,255,255,0.2) 0px 0.5px 0px 0px inset, rgba(0,0,0,0.2) 0px 0px 0px 0.5px inset,`
`rgba(0,0,0,0.05) 0px 1px 2px 0px``
- Active: opacity 0.8
- Focus: ``rgba(0,0,0,0.1) 0px 4px 12px`` shadow
- Use: Primary CTA ("Start Building", "Get Started")

Ghost / Outline

- Background: transparent
- Text: ``#1c1c1c``
- Padding: 8px 16px
- Radius: 6px

- Border: `1px solid rgba(28,28,28,0.4)`
- Active: opacity 0.8
- Focus: `rgba(0,0,0,0.1) 0px 4px 12px` shadow
- Use: Secondary actions ("Log In", "Documentation")

****Cream Surface****

- Background: `#f7f4ed`
- Text: `#1c1c1c`
- Padding: 8px 16px
- Radius: 6px
- No border
- Active: opacity 0.8
- Use: Tertiary actions, toolbar buttons

****Pill / Icon Button****

- Background: `#f7f4ed`
- Text: `#1c1c1c`
- Radius: 9999px (full pill)
- Shadow: same inset pattern as primary dark
- Opacity: 0.5 (default), 0.8 (active)
- Use: Additional actions, plan mode toggle, voice recording

Cards & Containers

- Background: `#f7f4ed` (matches page)
- Border: `1px solid #ecea4`
- Radius: 12px (standard), 16px (featured), 8px (compact)
- No box-shadow by default — borders define boundaries
- Image cards: `1px solid #ecea4` with 12px radius

Inputs & Forms

- Background: `#f7f4ed`
- Text: `#1c1c1c`
- Border: `1px solid #ecea4`
- Radius: 6px
- Focus: ring blue (`rgba(59,130,246,0.5)`) outline
- Placeholder: `#5f5f5d`

Navigation

- Clean horizontal nav on cream background, fixed
- Logo/wordmark left-aligned (128.75 x 22px)
- Links: Camera Plain 14–16px weight 400, `#1c1c1c` text
- CTA: dark button with inset shadow, 6px radius
- Mobile: hamburger menu with 6px radius button
- Subtle border or no border on scroll

Links

- Color: `#1c1c1c`
- Decoration: underline (default)

- Hover: primary accent (via CSS variable `hsl(var(--primary))`)
- No color change on hover — decoration carries the interactive signal

Image Treatment

- Showcase/portfolio images with `1px solid #e6e6e6` border
- Consistent 12px border radius on all image containers
- Soft gradient backgrounds behind hero content (warm multi-color wash)
- Gallery-style presentation for template/project showcases

Distinctive Components

AI Chat Input

- Large prompt input area with soft borders
- Suggestion pills with `#e6e6e6` borders
- Voice recording / plan mode toggle buttons as pill shapes (9999px)
- Warm, inviting input area — not clinical

Template Gallery

- Card grid showing project templates
- Each card: image + title, `1px solid #e6e6e6` border, 12px radius
- Hover: subtle shadow or border darkening
- Category labels as text links

Stats Bar

- Large metrics: "0M+" pattern in 48px+ weight 600
- Descriptive text below in muted gray
- Horizontal layout with generous spacing

5. Layout Principles

Spacing System

- Base unit: 8px
- Scale: 8px, 10px, 12px, 16px, 24px, 32px, 40px, 56px, 80px, 96px, 128px, 176px, 192px, 208px
- The scale expands generously at the top end — sections use 80px–208px vertical spacing for editorial breathing room

Grid & Container

- Max content width: approximately 1200px (centered)
- Hero: centered single-column with massive vertical padding (96px+)
- Feature sections: 2–3 column grids
- Full-width footer with multi-column link layout
- Showcase sections with centered card grids

Whitespace Philosophy

- ****Editorial generosity****: Lovable's spacing is lavish at section boundaries (80px–208px). The warm cream background makes these expanses feel cozy rather than empty.

- **Content-driven rhythm**: Tight internal spacing within cards (12–24px) contrasts with wide section gaps, creating a reading rhythm that alternates between focused content and visual rest.
- **Section separation**: Footer uses `1px solid #ecea4` border and 16px radius container. Sections defined by generous spacing rather than border lines.

Border Radius Scale

- Micro (4px): Small buttons, interactive elements
- Standard (6px): Buttons, inputs, navigation menu
- Comfortable (8px): Compact cards, divs
- Card (12px): Standard cards, image containers, templates
- Container (16px): Large containers, footer sections
- Full Pill (9999px): Action pills, icon buttons, toggles

6. Depth & Elevation

| Level | Treatment | Use |

|-----|-----|-----|

| Flat (Level 0) | No shadow, cream background | Page surface, most content |

| Bordered (Level 1) | `1px solid #ecea4` | Cards, images, dividers |

| Inset (Level 2) | `rgba(255,255,255,0.2) 0px 0.5px 0px inset, rgba(0,0,0,0.2) 0px 0px 0px 0.5px inset, rgba(0,0,0,0.05) 0px 1px 2px` | Dark buttons, primary actions |

| Focus (Level 3) | `rgba(0,0,0,0.1) 0px 4px 12px` | Active/focus states |

| Ring (Accessibility) | `rgba(59,130,246,0.5)` 2px ring | Keyboard focus on inputs |

Shadow Philosophy: Lovable's depth system is intentionally shallow. Instead of floating cards with dramatic drop-shadows, the system relies on warm borders (`#ecea4`) against the cream surface to create gentle containment. The only notable shadow pattern is the inset shadow on dark buttons — a subtle multi-layer technique where a white highlight line sits at the top edge while a dark ring and soft drop handle the bottom. This creates a tactile, pressed-into-surface feeling rather than a hovering-above-surface feeling. The warm focus shadow (`rgba(0,0,0,0.1) 0px 4px 12px`) is deliberately diffused and large, creating a soft glow rather than a sharp outline.

Decorative Depth

- Hero: soft, warm multi-color gradient wash (pinks, oranges, blues) behind hero — atmospheric, barely visible
- Footer: gradient background with warm tones transitioning to the bottom
- No harsh section dividers — spacing and background warmth handle transitions

7. Do's and Don'ts

Do

- Use the warm cream background (`#f7f4ed`) as the page foundation — it's the brand's signature warmth
- Use Camera Plain Variable at display sizes with negative letter-spacing (-0.9px to -1.5px)
- Derive all grays from `#1c1c1c` at varying opacity levels for tonal unity
- Use the inset shadow technique on dark buttons for tactile depth

- Use `#eae44` borders instead of shadows for card containment
- Keep the weight system narrow: 400 for body/UI, 600 for headings
- Use full-pill radius (9999px) only for action pills and icon buttons
- Apply opacity 0.8 on active states for responsive tactile feedback

Don't

- Don't use pure white (`#ffffff`) as a page background — the cream is intentional
- Don't use heavy box-shadows for cards — borders are the containment mechanism
- Don't introduce saturated accent colors — the palette is intentionally warm-neutral
- Don't use weight 700 (bold) — 600 is the maximum weight in the system
- Don't apply 9999px radius on rectangular buttons — pills are for icon/action toggles
- Don't use sharp focus outlines — the system uses soft shadow-based focus indicators
- Don't mix border styles — `#eae44` for passive, `rgba(28,28,28,0.4)` for interactive
- Don't increase letter-spacing on headings — Camera Plain is designed to run tight at scale

8. Responsive Behavior

Breakpoints

Name	Width	Key Changes
Mobile Small	<600px	Tight single column, reduced padding
Mobile	600–640px	Standard mobile layout
Tablet Small	640–700px	2-column grids begin
Tablet	700–768px	Card grids expand
Desktop Small	768–1024px	Multi-column layouts
Desktop	1024–1280px	Full feature layout
Large Desktop	1280–1536px	Maximum content width, generous margins

Touch Targets

- Buttons: 8px 16px padding (comfortable touch)
- Navigation: adequate spacing between items
- Pill buttons: 9999px radius creates large tap-friendly targets
- Menu toggle: 6px radius button with adequate sizing

Collapsing Strategy

- Hero: 60px → 48px → 36px headline scaling with proportional letter-spacing
- Navigation: horizontal links → hamburger menu at 768px
- Feature cards: 3-column → 2-column → single column stacked
- Template gallery: grid → stacked vertical cards
- Stats bar: horizontal → stacked vertical
- Footer: multi-column → stacked single column
- Section spacing: 128px+ → 64px on mobile

Image Behavior

- Template screenshots maintain `1px solid #eae44` border at all sizes
- 12px border radius preserved across breakpoints
- Gallery images responsive with consistent aspect ratios
- Hero gradient softens/simplifies on mobile

9. Agent Prompt Guide

Quick Color Reference

- Primary CTA: Charcoal (`#1c1c1c`)
- Background: Cream (`#f7f4ed`)
- Heading text: Charcoal (`#1c1c1c`)
- Body text: Muted Gray (`#5f5f5d`)
- Border: `#ecea4` (passive), `rgba(28,28,28,0.4)` (interactive)
- Focus: `rgba(0,0,0,0.1) 0px 4px 12px`
- Button text on dark: `#fcfbf8`

Example Component Prompts

- "Create a hero section on cream background (`#f7f4ed`). Headline at 60px Camera Plain Variable weight 600, line-height 1.10, letter-spacing -1.5px, color `#1c1c1c`. Subtitle at 18px weight 400, line-height 1.38, color `#5f5f5d`. Dark CTA button (`#1c1c1c` bg, `#fcfbf8` text, 6px radius, 8px 16px padding, inset shadow) and ghost button (transparent bg, 1px solid `rgba(28,28,28,0.4)` border, 6px radius)."
- "Design a card on cream (`#f7f4ed`) background. Border: 1px solid `#ecea4`. Radius 12px. No box-shadow. Title at 20px Camera Plain Variable weight 400, line-height 1.25, color `#1c1c1c`. Body at 14px weight 400, color `#5f5f5d`."
- "Build a template gallery: grid of cards with 12px radius, 1px solid `#ecea4` border, cream backgrounds. Each card: image with 12px top radius, title below. Hover: subtle border darkening."
- "Create navigation: sticky on cream (`#f7f4ed`). Camera Plain 16px weight 400 for links, `#1c1c1c` text. Dark CTA button right-aligned with inset shadow. Mobile: hamburger menu with 6px radius."
- "Design a stats section: large numbers at 48px Camera Plain weight 600, letter-spacing -1.2px, `#1c1c1c`. Labels below at 16px weight 400, `#5f5f5d`. Horizontal layout with 32px gap."

Iteration Guide

1. Always use cream (`#f7f4ed`) as the base — never pure white
2. Derive grays from `#1c1c1c` at opacity levels rather than using distinct hex values
3. Use `#ecea4` borders for containment, not shadows
4. Letter-spacing scales with size: -1.5px at 60px, -1.2px at 48px, -0.9px at 36px, normal at 16px
5. Two weights: 400 (everything except headings) and 600 (headings)
6. The inset shadow on dark buttons is the signature detail — don't skip it
7. Camera Plain Variable at weight 480 is for special display moments only